# Matthew Mettler

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University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign
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## EDUCATION

**Ph.D. in Political Science**, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign *Expected May 2027*

*Dissertation:* Fact–Opinion Differentiation Among Citizens: The Role of Partisan Identity, Cognitive Resources, and Media Cues

*Committee:* Jeffery Mondak (Chair), Damarys Canache, Brian Gaines, and Thomas Rudolph

**M.A. in International Relations**, University of South Dakota 2019

**B.S. in Political Science**, South Dakota State University 2013

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

**Primary Fields:** American Politics; Political Methodology

**Substantive Interests:** Political Behavior; Public Opinion; Political Communication; Misinformation; Democratic Accountability; Policy Feedback; Institutional Trust

**Methods:** Survey and experimental research; measurement; causal inference; compositional data analysis; applied statistical analysis and R programming

## PUBLICATIONS

### Book

Hibbing, M. V., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Raynal, I. R. (forthcoming, 2027). *(Mis)understanding the Other Side: How Americans Explain Opposing Political Views*. Temple University Press.

### Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Henderson, E., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Peffley, M. (2026). Experiential spillover in public views of police and courts. *Journal of Law and Courts*, 14(1), 238–258. [Article]

Canache, D., Knoll, N. J., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Indigenous quotas and symbolic representation in Latin America. *Journal of Politics in Latin America*, 18(3), 361-384. [Article]

McClinton, K. S., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Conceptualizing and measuring structural overlap in the political attitudes and orientations of multidimensional groups. *Social Science Quarterly*, 106(3), e70038. [Article]

Pagán Márquez, A. S., Djupe, P. A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2024). Was there an enthusiasm gap? Examining support for Donald Trump among evangelicals and nonevangelicals. *Politics and Religion*, 17(3), 410–430. [Article]

**Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2024). Fact–opinion differentiation. *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review, 5*(2). [Article]

## JOB MARKET PAPER

**Mettler, M.** Accuracy, Bias, or Noise in Political Judgments? A Compositional Approach to Fact–Opinion Classification.

## MANUSCRIPTS

### Revise and Resubmit

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Guardrails, Accomplices, or Bystanders? Citizen Response to Undemocratic Elite Cues. *Democratization*.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Three Tests of the Political Impact of Individual-Level Variation in the Negativity Bias. *Journal of Experimental Political Science*.

### Under Review

Mullins, S., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Deep in Thought or Deeply Biased? Cognitive Ability and Motivated Reasoning.

Griffin, C., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Exploring the Impact of Alternate Framings of Czechia on American Attitudes towards Czechs.

### Working Papers

**Mettler, M.** Nudging Away from Bias: Accuracy Prompting and Partisan Fact–Opinion Classification.

**Mettler, M.** Facts by Association: How Media & Partisan Cues Shape Political Fact–Opinion Classification.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Strojny, L. M. There but for Misfortune: The Impact of Economic Information and Misinformation on Voting in the 2024 U.S. Presidential Election.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. A Multidimensional Approach to Measuring Misinformation Response Tendencies.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. A Targeted Strategy for Improving the Mass Public's Capacity to Identify True and False Political Claims.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Creating Measures of Retrospective Perceptions beyond Economic Indicators.

Lim, Y., & **Mettler, M.** Moral Tradeoffs in Candidate Choice: When Do Evangelical Voters Excuse Misconduct?

## POLICY REPORTS AND PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2023). Eviction expectations in the aftermath of the pandemic moratoria. *University of Illinois College of Law Legal Studies Research Paper*, No. 24-06. [Article]

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2023). Texas's movement to online court is sensible, but more study should follow. *Voice for the Defense*, 20–22. [Article]

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2022). Race and eviction during the pandemic. *Institute of Government and Public Affairs Policy Spotlight*. [Article]

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2022). Courts and the housing market. *News-Gazette*. [Article]

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, Wilson, R. F., & Miller, A. (2022). The impact of COVID-19 on state court proceedings: Five key findings. *Institute of Government and Public Affairs Policy Spotlight*. [Article]

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Mullins, S., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2026). Deep in Thought or Deeply Biased? Cognitive Ability and Motivated Reasoning. Paper presented at the American Political Science Association's Annual Meeting, Boston, Massachusetts.

Griffin, C., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2026). Exploring the Impact of Alternate Framings of Czechia on American Attitudes towards Czechs. Paper presented at the American Political Science Association's Annual Meeting, Boston, Massachusetts.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2026). The political impact of individual-level variation in the negativity bias. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology, Newcastle, United Kingdom.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2026). Economic realities, partisan fictions: Facts, perceptions, and partisan bias in economic voting. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.

Henderson, E., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Peffley, M. (2025). Experiential spillover in public views of police and courts. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association, Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Elite cues can induce the erosion of democratic support: Evidence from two U.S. surveys. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology, Prague, Czech Republic.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Fostering political lie detection. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Measuring and modeling misinformation: A strategy for assessing the relative prevalence of partisan and residual error. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.

Lim, Y., & **Mettler, M.** (2025). When to tolerate immorality by elected officials and when not to. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Elite cues and Americans' support for authoritarian world leaders. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Southern Political Science Association, San Juan, Puerto Rico.

Canache, D., Knoll, N. J., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2024). Indigenous quotas and perceived representation in Latin America. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the European Political Science Association, Cologne, Germany.

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2022). Race and eviction during the pandemic. Paper presented at the Race and Social Justice Symposium, Champaign, Illinois.

## TEACHING AND MENTORING

### Instructor of Record

| | |
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| The U.S. Supreme Court | Summer 2026 |
| Politics and the Media | Fall 2025 |
| Introduction to American Politics (Co-instructor) | Spring 2025 |
| Introduction to Politics | Fall 2024 |

### Teaching Assistant

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| State Government in the United States | Fall 2026 |
| Introduction to International Relations | Spring 2026 |
| Strategic International Relations | Spring 2024 |
| Junior Honors Seminar | Fall 2023 |
| Introduction to Political Behavior | Fall 2023 |

### Graduate Methods Instruction

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| Political Science Math Camp: Probability and R Programming | 2025 |
| Political Science Math Camp: Probability and R Programming | 2024 |
| Political Science Math Camp: Linear Regression and R Programming | 2023 |

### Undergraduate Research Mentoring

**Josh Ellison** 2026

*Challenging the Partisan Voter: A Two-Dimensional Model of Vote Choice Beyond Ideology*

*Undergraduate Thesis Best Poster Award, UIUC Department of Political Science*

**Nathan Knoll** 2025

*Effects of Legislative Gender Quotas on Political Efficacy*

**Kenneth Dolin** 2025

*The Role of the Poll: Polling (Dis)trust and Increased Voter Turnout*

*Honorable Mention, Undergraduate Thesis Best Poster Award, UIUC Department of Political Science*

**Kennedy McClinton** 2024

*Conceptualizing and Measuring Structural Overlap in the Political Attitudes and Orientations of Multidimensional Groups*

**Vindhya Kalipi** 2024

*I'm Just a Bill: The Impact of Civic Education on Democratic Engagement*

**Alondra S. Pagán Márquez** 2023

*Was There an Enthusiasm Gap? Examining Support for Donald Trump among Evangelicals and Nonevangelicals*

**Emma Henderson** 2023

*Experiential Spillover in Public Views of Police and Courts*

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

**Research Assistant**

**Institute of Government and Public Affairs** 2021–2022

- Collaborated with a team of scholars investigating the effects of COVID-19 on state court systems.
- Prepared policy reports for publication through the Institute's Access to Justice Initiative.
- Conducted in-depth interviews with court officials for policy research projects.

## AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Dissertation Completion Fellowship ($12,000), University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign 2026

MPSA Travel Grant, Department of Political Science 2025, 2026

List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Their Students, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign 2025, 2026

Summer Dissertation Fellowship ($3,000), Department of Political Science 2025

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

### Reviewer

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| *Political Behavior* | 2026 |
| Institute of Government and Public Affairs (policy-report review) | 2026 |
| *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review* | 2026 |

### Departmental Service

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| Faculty Search Committee, Graduate Representative | 2024 |
| Political Science Math Camp Committee | 2023–2025 |

## MEDIA AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

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| *The 21st Show*, Illinois Public Media | 2024 |
| WTAX, Illinois statewide radio | 2023 |
| WCIA-TV, Champaign, Illinois | 2023 |
| *CBS Chicago Morning Show* | 2023 |

## PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association

International Society of Political Psychology

Midwest Political Science Association